



University of
Nottingham

UK | CHINA | MALAYSIA

Eol and Pitch Preparation

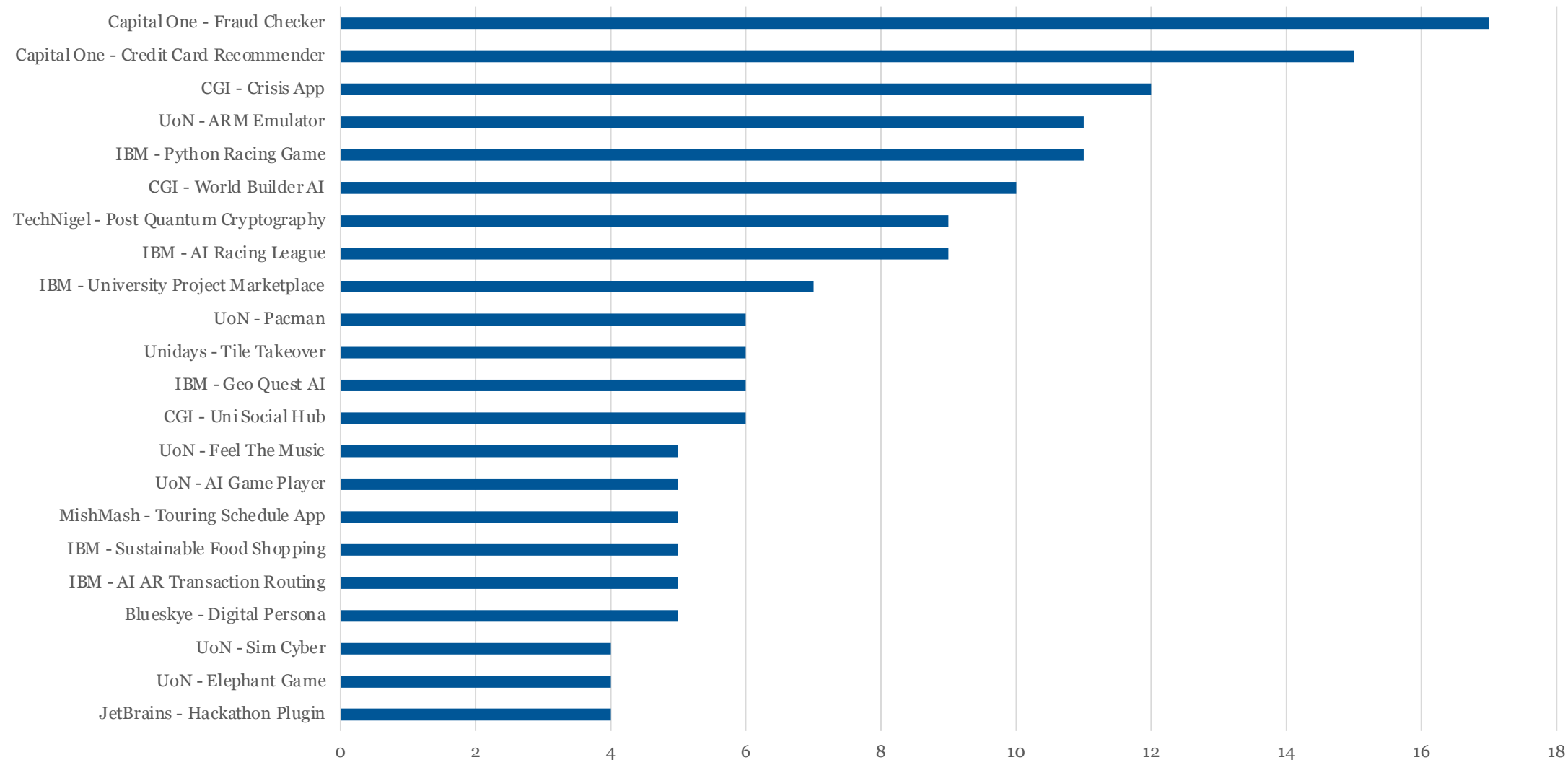
Dr Dan Marsden

2026



Projects Feedback

Top three choices





Projects Feedback

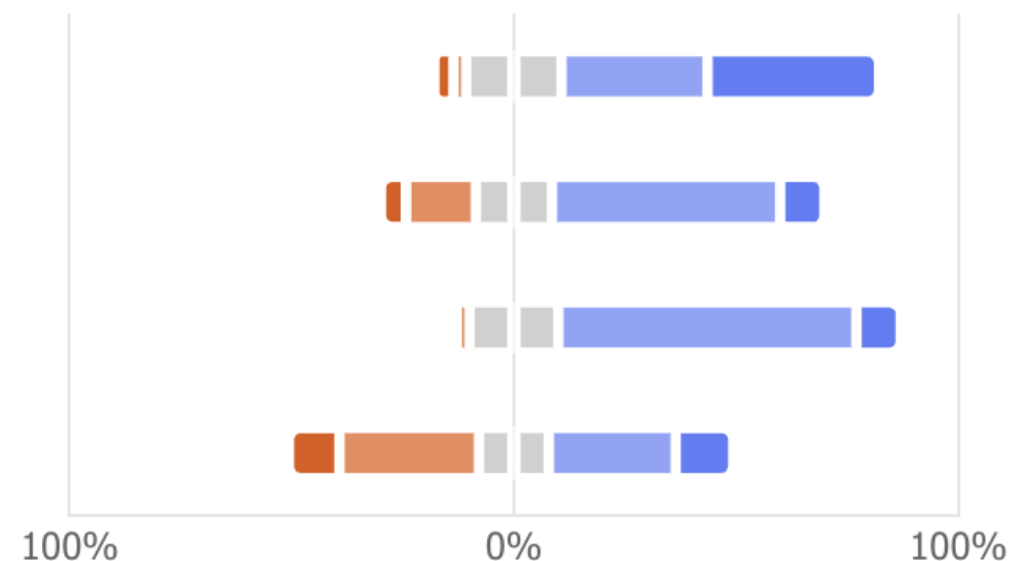
● Strongly Disagree ● Disagree ● Neither agree not disagree ● Agree ● Strongly Agree

I prefer industry projects

I was happy with the choice of projects

The project briefs gave enough information

I would be happy to work on most of the projects





Projects Feedback

- **More of:**
 - Industry projects!
 - Robotics
 - Cybersecurity
 - Hardware
 - Cloud engineering and other SWE industry tasks
 - Quantitative finance
 - Programming languages
 - AI/ML
 - Games
- **Less of:**
 - LLM slop projects
 - AI/ML
 - Games



If you have differing views, fill out the form!



- **Deadlines:**

- 14th of October:
 - CV / EoI / Pitch Video submission deadline (Team Admin)
 - CV submission deadline (everyone, individually)
 - Use the submission format specified in Moodle – Directory structure and file names.
- 19th of October (10:00 – 13:00): pitch day
 - Some projects may be on a different day

- **20th of October: project award (may run later for practical reasons)**

- Contact the academic supervisor and sponsor ASAP after the project award



State of Play

- **Everyone is signed up for three pitches**
 - They may even include things you don't want
- **You will bid for the projects through Eols and pitches**
 - Industry sponsors and academics are **there to help you!**
- **Every team will get a project**
 - But not all will get their first choice (but all will be OK 😊)



- **All Eols and pitches are marked (12% of total):**
 - The **average** of all three results in the final Eoi mark (see rubric)
 - **Do not** game the system by writing bad Eols for a projects you don't want
 - Better Eols and pitches have a **higher chance** getting the 1st choice
- **The Eoi template on Moodle must be used**
 - Don't go above 750 words
 - CVs can be up to 2 pages



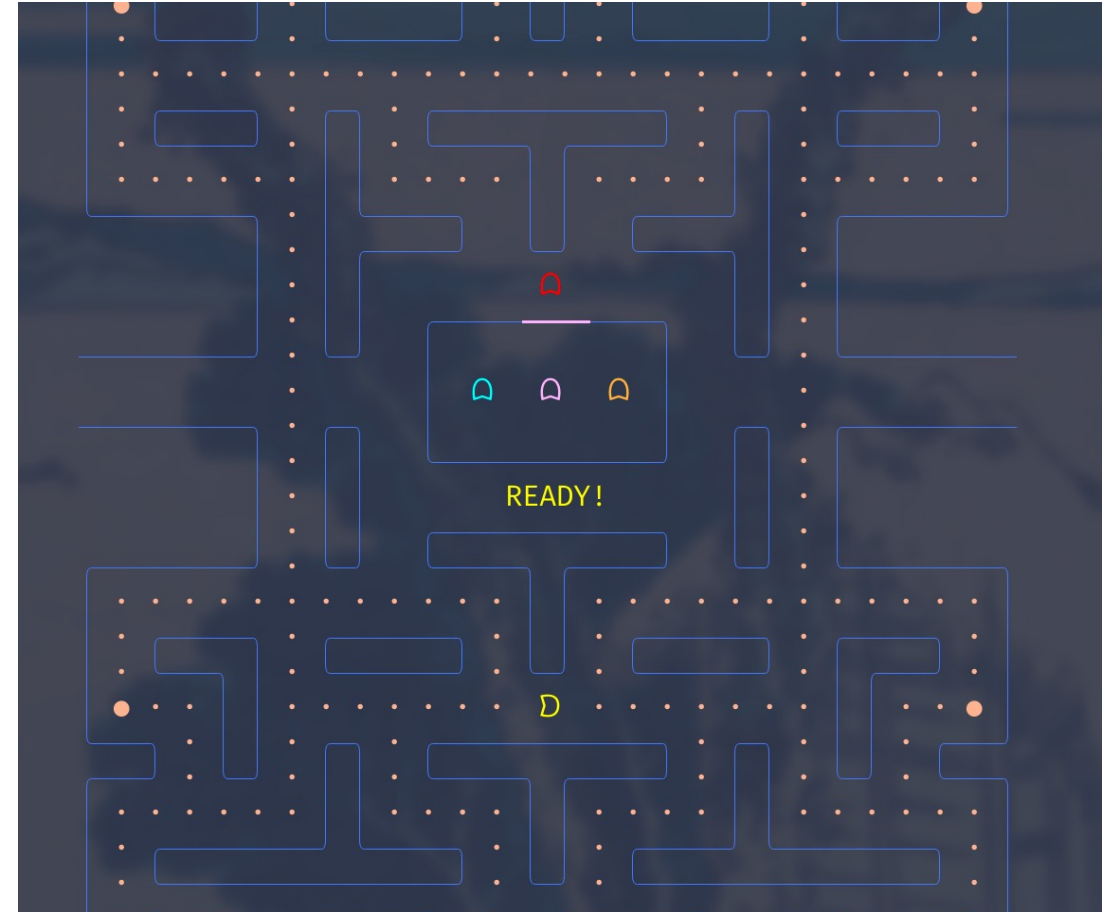
Eol: What to Consider?

- Motivation (20%)
- Understanding of the brief and context (20%)
- Preliminary analysis (30%)
- Management (20%)
- Style (10%)



Three Key Points

- Write tailored expressions of interest per project
- Work in sub-teams and harness diversity of the team
- Aim to convey enthusiasm – show you care about the project





- **What to consider:**
 - Motivation for the project
 - Understanding of sponsor
 - Matching of team skills to project
- **How to achieve this:**
 - Tailor the Eols to the projects
 - Convey why **you** think the project is important and worth solving
 - Show ambition for what can be done in the project – **modern dev tools (a.k.a AI) mean we can be more ambitious than previous years**

Summary: show enthusiasm and investment in the project.



- **What to consider:**

- Understanding of the brief
- The wider context of the project
- Existing products or competitors

- **How to achieve this:**

- Carry out background research on the project
 - Go beyond the brief
 - Investigate the company and other stakeholders
 - Consider the environment your software would exist in – existing solutions, competitors
- Contact the sponsor for additional clarification (only if necessary)



- **What to consider:**
 - Proposed initial approach and motivation
 - Applicable technologies and methods
 - Potential challenges
- **How to achieve this:**
 - Suggest a **specific** preliminary design
 - Are there relevant alternatives to what is proposed?
 - Suggest and compare approaches
 - Give an **unbiased** assessment
 - Cover all aspects of the problem
 - Are there potential extensions or generalisations?



- **What to consider:**

- The project management approach
- Preliminary high level project plan and timescales
- Identification risks and mitigations

- **How to achieve this:**

- **Briefly** explain how you will manage the project – agile methodology
- What are the key parts of the project, who will address them
- Risk analysis:
 - Skill gaps, availability, competing workload, project specifics
 - Mitigations (e.g. paired programming, fallback plan)

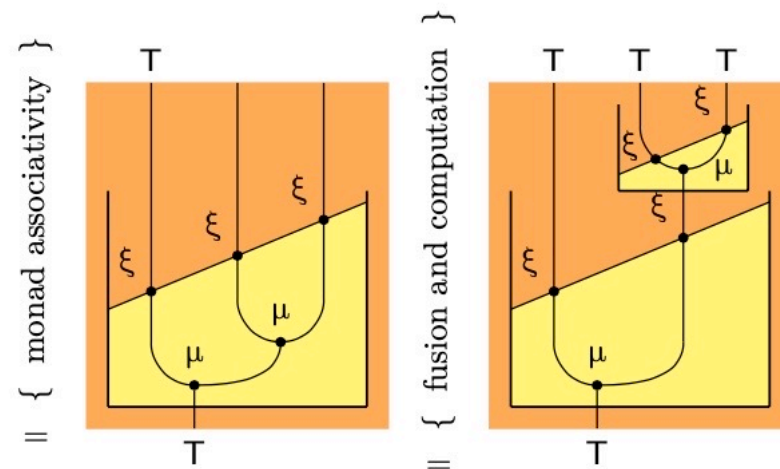
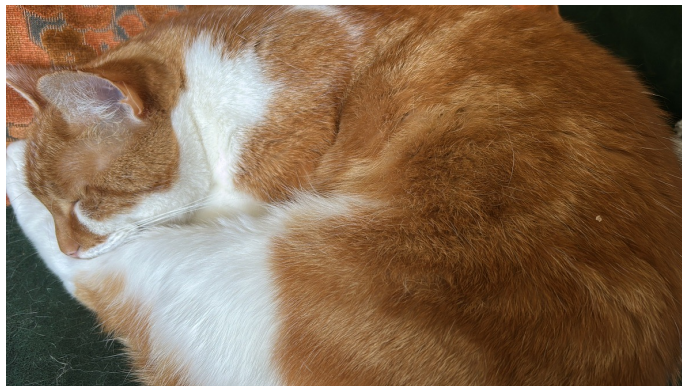


- **What to consider:**

- Structure
- Editorial standards
- **Make it interesting!**

- **How to achieve this:**

- Consider what sections you need, and in what order – important stuff early
- Pay attention to layout, grammar and spelling – proofread and use tools
- Pictures, diagrams, examples, analogies





Expression of Interest	Motivation (20%)	Criteria: - Motivation / interest for the project - Motivation / understanding of sponsor (if applicable) - Matching of team skills to project
	Understanding of the brief and context (20%)	Criteria: - Understanding of the brief - Analysis and understanding of the wider context of the project - Analysis and understanding of existing products / competitors
	Preliminary Analysis (30%)	Criteria: - Discussion of applicable tools / libraries / methods - Proposed initial approach and motivation - Identification of challenges and issues
	Management (20%)	Criteria: - Project management approach discussed - Preliminary / high level project plan and timescales - Identification of challenges / skills gaps / contingency plans
	Style (10%)	Criteria: - Formatting - Language / grammar / spelling

- **Five to ten minutes maximum presentation (submit in .mp4)**
- **A potential structure could be:**
 - Introduction (1 minute)
 - Understanding of the project context
 - Technical analysis
 - Proposed approach and relative merits
 - Reasons why they should choose you
 - Summary of key points (1 minute)

- **Preparation:**
 - Choose a pitch video lead
 - Consider the audience
 - Plan – consider a script
 - Rehearse
- **Prepare some slides (maximum 5 – 6)**
 - Avoid overloading them with content
 - Use visual elements
 - **Don't** use company logos without permission!





- **Content:**
 - Sections from the EoI remain relevant
 - Consider introducing a preliminary approach and mock-up
 - Brief project management remarks
 - What will you require from the sponsor – data, specialist equipment
- **Team involvement:**
 - One or many presenters
 - The team should ensure everyone has the chance to contribute **somehow**
 - As individuals, make sure you do contribute **somehow**

- **Style and delivery:**
 - Make it interesting!
 - Convey enthusiasm
 - Act united as a team not a collection of individuals
 - Make sure you are audible
 - Appropriate humour is good



Presenting will probably feel embarrassing or awkward



- **Schedule TBC – 19th October, unless rearranged by sponsor**
- **Q&A – Be ready to:**
 - Respond to questions – game out before hand
 - Play the appropriate pitch video if the sponsor has not watched it
 - Ask some questions of your own – prepare in advance



Rubric

Pitch	Style & Delivery of the Pitch (25%)	Criteria: - Delivery (clarity / structure) - Team attitude (engaging, motivation, enthusiasm, honesty, ...) - Interaction and contributions of individual team members (unified team?)
	Materials (25%)	Criteria: - Visual elements (diagrams / flowcharts / animations / handouts) - Clarity, spelling, grammar of the slides
	Content (35%)	Criteria: - Tailored to the brief - Technical analysis - Preliminary approach / design - Project management approach
	Q&A (15%)	Criteria: - Concise, to the point, correct



- **After the pitches:**
 - Discuss the **team's preference** order for the different projects
 - This may have changed after the pitches
 - Team admin completes the **preference form**
- **Your CVs will be marked by an academic**



Finally

- **Be on time and know how to start the meeting**
 - You will be routed through the “lobby”
- **Test the equipment**
- **Enjoy!**

Eol and Pitch Preparation - Core Revision Summary

bidding process · Eol rubric · preliminary analysis · project management · pitch video · Q&A · project allocation

◆ lecturer-emphasized / highlighted content

1. Topic Overview

This lecture explains the **project bidding stage** of COMP2002: teams compete for projects through **Expressions of Interest (Eols), pitch videos and Q&A**. Every team will receive a project, but a first choice is **not guaranteed**; stronger bids improve the chance of receiving the preferred project. The lecture therefore treats the Eol and pitch as both **assessed work** and a practical case for convincing a sponsor/academic that the team understands the problem and can deliver it.

Lecture logic: understand the brief and sponsor → research the wider context → propose and compare a preliminary technical approach → show team fit and project-management thinking → communicate it clearly in Eol + pitch → defend it in Q&A → rank projects and enter allocation.

2. Core Concepts

Bidding process and key dates

- ▶ ◆ **14 October:** Team Admin submits CV / Eol / Pitch Video materials; **every student also submits their CV individually**. Use Moodle's required directory structure and file names.
- ▶ **19 October, 10:00-13:00:** Pitch Day; a sponsor may rearrange a project's session to another day.
- ▶ ◆ **20 October:** project award, although this may run later for practical reasons. After allocation, contact the academic supervisor and sponsor **ASAP**.
- ▶ Everyone is signed up for **three pitches**; those three can include projects the team does not prefer. Every team gets a project, but not necessarily its first choice.

Eol purpose and constraints

- ▶ ◆ All Eols and pitches are marked and together form **12% of the module**; the average of the three results contributes to the final Eol mark.
- ▶ ◆ **Do not game the system** by deliberately writing a weak Eol for an unwanted project. Better Eols/pitches increase the chance of getting the first choice.
- ▶ Use the **Moodle Eol template**; Eol maximum **750 words**; CV maximum **2 pages**.
- ▶ Three lecturer takeaways: **tailor each Eol**, exploit the team's diverse skills via sub-teams, and **show genuine enthusiasm** for the project.

Eol rubric: what the marker is looking for

- ▶ **Motivation (20%):** interest in the project; understanding of sponsor; matching team skills to the project. Explain why the problem is important/worth solving and show ambition.
- ▶ **Understanding of brief and context (20%):** understand the brief, wider context, stakeholders, existing products and competitors. **Go beyond the brief** through background research; contact the sponsor only when clarification is genuinely needed.
- ▶ ◆ **Preliminary Analysis (30%):** the highest-weight Eol section. Discuss applicable tools/libraries/methods, propose a **specific preliminary design**, identify challenges, compare relevant alternatives, and give an unbiased assessment. Consider extensions/generalisation where appropriate.
- ▶ **Management (20%):** project-management approach, high-level plan/timescales, responsibilities, risks and mitigations. Agile is the suggested framing; risks include skill gaps, availability, competing workload and project-specific issues.
- ▶ **Style (10%):** formatting, structure, language, grammar and spelling. Put important material early; use diagrams/examples/analogies when they improve clarity.

3. Key Mechanisms / Algorithms

1) Eol construction pipeline

Research → **brief + wider context** → **motivation / team fit** → **specific preliminary design** → **alternatives + challenges** → **management / risk** → **proofread + visual structure**

1. Research the sponsor, stakeholders, existing solutions and competitors before writing.
2. Translate the project brief into a concrete problem statement and explain why it matters.
3. Match the team's evidence/skills to that problem rather than making generic claims.
4. Propose a preliminary design with suitable technologies/methods; compare plausible alternatives and explain trade-offs.
5. Add a high-level delivery plan: key work areas, likely owners, timescales, risks, mitigations and fallback options.
6. Edit for structure and persuasion: important material first, concise language, consistent layout and useful visuals.

2) Pitch-video structure and preparation

- ▶ ♦ Pitch video length: **5-10 minutes maximum**, submitted as **.mp4**.
- ▶ Suggested flow: **Introduction (about 1 min)** → project context → technical analysis → proposed approach and relative merits → why the sponsor should choose your team → **summary (about 1 min)**.
- ▶ Choose a pitch lead, consider the audience, plan/script the delivery, and **rehearse**.
- ▶ ♦ Prepare only **5-6 slides maximum**; avoid overloading them with text and use visual elements. **Do not use company logos without permission**.
- ▶ Eol sections remain relevant in the pitch. A preliminary approach/mock-up, brief management remarks, and sponsor dependencies (e.g. data or specialist equipment) are useful additions.

3) Team delivery and live Q&A

- ▶ One or multiple presenters are acceptable, but **every team member should have an opportunity to contribute somehow**; as an individual, ensure you do contribute.
- ▶ Delivery should be clear, audible and engaging. ♦ Act as a **unified team**, not a collection of individuals; enthusiasm and appropriate humour are encouraged.
- ▶ For Q&A, game out likely questions in advance, be ready to play the pitch if the sponsor has not watched it, and prepare useful questions of your own.
- ▶ Q&A answers should be **concise, to the point and correct**; do not turn a short clarification into an improvised second presentation.

4) Allocation flow after pitching

Complete pitches / Q&A → **re-discuss team preference order** → **Team Admin submits preference form** → **project award** → **contact supervisor + sponsor ASAP**

The team's preference order may legitimately change after the pitches. CVs are marked separately by an academic.

4. Formula / Rules / Conditions

- ▶ **Eol rubric:** Motivation 20% + Brief/Context 20% + Preliminary Analysis 30% + Management 20% + Style 10% = **100%**.
- ▶ **Pitch rubric:** Style & Delivery 25% + Materials 25% + Content 35% + Q&A 15% = **100%**.
- ▶ **Pitch Content (35%):** tailored to the brief; technical analysis; preliminary approach/design; project-management approach.
- ▶ **Pitch Style & Delivery (25%):** clarity/structure; engaging and honest team attitude; visible interaction/contribution across the team.
- ▶ **Pitch Materials (25%):** diagrams/flowcharts/animations/handouts where useful; clear slides with correct spelling and grammar.
- ▶ **Hard limits / submission conditions:** Eol $\leq$ 750 words; CV $\leq$ 2 pages; pitch = 5-10 min; slides $\leq$ 5-6; company logos require permission; Moodle submission structure/file names must be followed.

Operational condition: be on time, know how to start the meeting, expect to be routed through the meeting "lobby", and test equipment beforehand.

5. Comparison & Common Confusions

Concept A	Concept B	Key Difference / Revision Point
Generic/reused Eol	Tailored Eol	The lecture explicitly requires a project-specific case: motivation, sponsor/context research, team fit and technical approach should change with the project.
Restating the brief	Understanding wider context	High marks require going beyond the supplied brief: stakeholders, company context, environment, competitors and existing solutions.
Technology list	Specific preliminary design	Naming tools is insufficient on its own; show how they form an initial solution and why they suit the problem.
Single preferred approach	Unbiased comparison	Preliminary analysis should consider alternatives, compare trade-offs, identify challenges and justify the proposed direction.
Detailed final plan	Preliminary high-level plan	At bidding stage you are not expected to know every implementation detail; you should show credible phases, timescales, ownership, risks and contingencies.
Strong individuals	Unified team	Pitch marking rewards a coherent team attitude and visible contribution/interaction, not a set of disconnected mini-presentations.
Text-heavy slides	Visual pitch materials	Slides should support the spoken argument with diagrams, flowcharts, mock-ups or other visuals; maximum 5-6 slides.
Pitch video	Live Q&A	The video presents the prepared case; Q&A tests whether the team can answer sponsor questions concisely and intelligently in real time.
Preference ranking	Guaranteed project	Ranking expresses preference only. Every team gets a project, but the first choice is not guaranteed; Eol/pitch quality influences allocation chance.
Before-pitch preference	After-pitch preference	Teams should re-discuss the order after pitches because new information can legitimately change priorities.

6. Exam / Revision Focus

Must Know

- ▶ **Dates:** 14 Oct submission; 19 Oct Pitch Day (subject to sponsor rearrangement); 20 Oct project award (may run later).
- ▶ **Constraints:** Eol ≤ 750 words, CV ≤ 2 pages, pitch 5-10 min, 5-6 slides maximum, Moodle directory/file naming rules.
- ▶ **Eol weights:** 20 / 20 / **30** / 20 / 10 for Motivation / Context / Preliminary Analysis / Management / Style.
- ▶ **Pitch weights:** 25 / 25 / **35** / 15 for Style & Delivery / Materials / Content / Q&A.
- ▶ **Three Eol principles:** tailor per project; use team diversity/sub-teams; convey enthusiasm and investment.

Must Understand

- ▶ Why **Preliminary Analysis** carries the largest Eol weight: the bid must show concrete technical thinking, not only interest.
- ▶ Why context research matters: a good solution must fit the sponsor, stakeholders, existing products and real operating environment.
- ▶ Why management/risk belongs in a technical bid: sponsors need evidence the team can organise work, handle skill gaps and recover when plans fail.
- ▶ Why delivery matters independently of content: clear visuals, rehearsal, audibility, team unity and concise Q&A are explicitly assessed.

Easy to Confuse

- ▶ **Higher-quality Eol/pitch increases the chance** of first choice; it does **not** guarantee allocation.
- ▶ **Every team gets a project**, but one or more of the three pitches may be for projects the team originally did not want.
- ▶ Do **not** deliberately weaken unwanted bids: all Eols/pitches are marked and the three results are averaged.
- ▶ Sponsor contact before bidding is for **necessary clarification**, not a substitute for your own background research.
- ▶ A pitch should contain enough technical detail to show credibility, but it remains a **preliminary** approach, not a finished design.
- ▶ Company branding is not automatically reusable: **logos require permission**.

Source emphasis incorporated: deadlines, rubric weights, bold/marked constraints, and lecturer takeaways from the Eol, Pitch, Q&A and Allocation sections (pp.6-24).